

Lara Kelly-Iturriaga

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EDUCATION

PhD in Linguistics and English Language, The University of Edinburgh

SEPTEMBER 2023 – PRESENT

- Provisional title: *The role of language distance in bilingual lexical processing*
- Exploring the effect of language distance on language co-activation in bilinguals and trilinguals during L2 processing using four psycholinguistic experiments
- Supervisors: Professor Mitsuhiro Ota and Professor Martin Pickering

MA in Applied Linguistics and Language Acquisition in Multilingual Contexts, University of Barcelona

SEPTEMBER 2021 – JULY 2022

- MA thesis: Do you eat *pasta* for dessert and *tender* your clothes? A comparison of cross-language activation in Turkish and Spanish learners of English
- GPA: 9.4/10 (Distinction)

BA in Political Science and Public-Sector Management, University of the Basque Country (UPV/EHU)

SEPTEMBER 2016 – JUNE 2020

- Dissertation: Linguistic and Sociolinguistic Policies: Multilingualism and Minority Languages in the UK
- GPA: 7.22/10 (2:1)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, The University of Edinburgh

SEPTEMBER 2025 – PRESENT

- Piloted eye-tracking experiment with three participants and using mouse simulation
- Designed sentence stimuli for eye-tracking experiments exploring the effects of cognitive load (syntactic complexity) on language prediction
- ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL RESEARCH COUNCIL (ESRC)-funded project on '*Predicting language under difficult conditions: Effects of cognitive load, noise, and hearing impairment*' – PI: Martin Pickering

Research Assistant, University of Barcelona

FEBRUARY 2022

- Conducted audio transcription and phonetic labelling in Praat, assessing complexity, accuracy and fluency of L2 speech samples
- SPANISH MINISTRY OF SCIENCE, INNOVATION AND UNIVERSITIES-funded project on '*Pro-nunciation and phono-lexical representations in Spanish EFL learners: assessing the benefits of phonetic training and form-focused instructed SLA (PhonLex-iSLA)*' – PI: Joan C. Mora

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Academic Tutor, The University of Edinburgh

SEPTEMBER 2023 – PRESENT

2026-2027

- DATA ANALYSIS FOR PSYCHOLOGY IN R-2: delivering weekly R labs to 60 undergraduate students (Year 2).
- UNIVARIATE STATISTICS AND METHODOLOGY USING R: delivering weekly R labs to 30-40 MSc students.
- SCHOOL OF PHILOSOPHY, PSYCHOLOGY AND LANGUAGE SCIENCES (PPLS) SKILLS CENTRE: delivering one-on-one writing sessions to advanced undergraduate and MSc students to help them become confident, independent writers; providing tailored academic writing advice.

2025-2026

- SECOND LANGUAGE ACQUISITION & FIRST LANGUAGE ACQUISITION: delivered weekly tutorials to 10-20 advanced undergraduate students (Years 3-4) and marked data analyses, research proposals and exams
- QUANTITATIVE METHODS FOR LINGUISTICS AND ENGLISH LANGUAGE (LEL): delivered weekly R workshops to 40-50 students and marked self-reflections and research projects in joint advanced undergraduate and MSc course
- PPLS SKILLS CENTRE: delivered one-on-one writing sessions to advanced undergraduate and MSc students.

2024-2025

- SECOND LANGUAGE ACQUISITION & FIRST LANGUAGE ACQUISITION: delivered weekly tutorials to 10 advanced undergraduate students and marked data analyses, research proposals and exams

2023-2024

- LEL1B: delivered weekly tutorials to Year 1 undergraduate students on phonology, sociolinguistics, historical phonology and morphology, syntax, semantics and pragmatics, and sign language linguistics. Marked essays and final exams.
- LEL2B: PHONETIC ANALYSIS AND EMPIRICAL METHODS: delivered weekly tutorials to Year 2 undergraduate students on 1) phonetic analysis using Praat and 2) empirical methods. Marked acoustic phonetics and empirical methods lab reports.

Guest Lecturer, The University of Edinburgh

JANUARY 2026

Designed teaching materials and delivered lecture on ‘The bilingual lexicon’ for SECOND LANGUAGE ACQUISITION (MSc & advanced undergraduate students)

PUBLICATIONS

Published

Leivada, E., **Kelly-Iturriaga, L.**, Masullo, C., Westergaard, M., & Rothman, J. (2025). The unpredictable role of language distance in bilingual cognition: A systematic review from brain to behavior. *Bilingualism: Language and Cognition*, 1–14. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S1366728925100746> [Q1 Linguistics, IF 2.4].

Pre-prints & in prep

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M., Uzun, L., Salihoğlu, U. M., & Çetinavcı, U. R. (2026). *Introducing LexTurk: A quick lexical test for learners of Turkish*. PsyArXiv. osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/tbhgv_v1

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M., Ota, M., & Pickering, M. J. (2026). *The effect of language distance on bilingual lexical processing: Evidence from interlingual homographs*. [Invited revision].

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M.*, Ota, M. & Pickering, M. J. (2026). Language distance effects on trilingual lexical processing. *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing 2026 (AMLaP2026)*, Saarland University, Saarbrücken. Poster presentation.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M.*, Ota, M. & Pickering, M. J. (2026). Does language distance affect bilingual lexical processing? *35th Annual Conference of the European Second Language Association (EuroSLA 35)*, Research Center for Linguistics (CLUNL) at NOVA University Lisbon. Oral presentation.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M.*, Ota, M. & Pickering, M. J. (2026). Language distance effects on bilingual lexical processing: evidence from interlingual homographs. *6th International Symposium on Bilingual and L2 Processing in Adults and Children (ISBPAC 2026)*, University of Reading. Oral presentation.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M.*, Ota, M. & Pickering, M. J. (2025). The effect of language distance on bilingual lexical processing. *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing 2025 (AMLaP2025)*, Charles University, Prague. Poster presentation.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M. (2025). The role of language distance in bilingual language processing. *15th International Symposium on Bilingualism*, Basque Center on Cognition, Brain and Language (BCBL), Donostia-San Sebastián. Poster presentation.

Leivada, E.*, **Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M.**, Masullo, C., Westergaard, M. & Rothman, J. (2025). The impact of language similarity on cognitive adaptations to bilingualism. *15th International Symposium on Bilingualism*, BCBL, Donostia-San Sebastián. Poster presentation.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M. (2025). The role of language distance in bilingual language processing. *Linguistics and English Language Postgraduate Conference 2025*, The University of Edinburgh. Oral presentation.

Leivada, E., Blanco-Elorrieta, E., **Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M.***, Masullo, C., Westergaard, M. & Rothman, J. (2025). Exploring the role of language distance in bilingual cognition: A systematic review. *Bilingualism Matters Symposium 2025*, Edinburgh. Poster presentation.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M. (2024). Do you eat *pasta* for dessert and *tender* your clothes? Cross-language activation in L1-Turkish and L1-Spanish learners of English. *30th Linguistics and English Language Postgraduate Conference*, The University of Edinburgh. Poster presentation.

INVITED TALKS

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M. (2026). Language distance effects on bilingual lexical processing: broadening the picture. *Psycholinguistics Coffee*, The University of Edinburgh. 31st of March 2026.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M. (2026). Does language distance affect bilingual lexical processing? *Simone Sulpizio's lab meeting*, University of Milano-Bicocca. 27th of February 2026.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M. (2026). The effect of language distance on bilingual lexical processing. *Bilingualism and Developmental Linguistics Research Group*, The University of Edinburgh. 26th of February 2026.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M. (2025). The role of language distance in bilingual lexical processing. *Psycholinguistics Coffee*, The University of Edinburgh. 18th of June 2025.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M. (2024). Linguistic Distance, Psychotypology and Bilingual Language Processing. *Psycholinguistics Coffee*, The University of Edinburgh. 29th of May 2024.

Kelly-Iturriaga, L. M. (2024). The role of typology in the bilingual mental lexicon. *Bilingualism and Developmental Linguistics Research Group*, The University of Edinburgh. 18th of March 2024.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

AHRC PhD Scholarship, Scottish Graduate School for Arts & Humanities (SGSAH) SEPTEMBER 2024 – PRESENT

ARTS AND HUMANITIES RESEARCH COUNCIL (AHRC) studentship covering maintenance, tuition fees and additional research funding. Total funds awarded: £69,412.67

Research Support Grants, PPLS, The University of Edinburgh SEPTEMBER 2023 – PRESENT

Grants for participant payment and research-related travel. Total funds awarded: £3,422.22

First Place and People's Choice Awards, PPLS Three Minute Thesis (3MT), The University of Edinburgh MARCH 2026

Prizes awarded for delivering the best research presentation in just 3 minutes (and one slide). Total funds awarded: £100

Training & Development Grant, PPLS, The University of Edinburgh SEPTEMBER 2024 – JUNE 2025

Grant providing funds for BDLRG external speakers' travel and accommodation and catering. Total funds awarded: £785.56

Student Conference Funding, LAGB Postgraduate Student Committee MARCH 2025

Grant for travel/accommodation for students from underrepresented backgrounds to present at LELPGC25. Total funds awarded: £150

Erasmus+ Grant, Spanish Service for the Internationalisation of Education (SEPIE) SEPTEMBER 2018 – JUNE 2019

Mobility grant for Erasmus+ programme at Alma Mater Studiorum – Università di Bologna, Italy. Total funds awarded: €2,250

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Undergraduate dissertation co-supervisor, The University of Edinburgh SEPTEMBER 2026 – PRESENT

Co-supervising undergraduate dissertation on *The effect of language distance on code-switching* with Professor Mitsuhiro Ota

Volunteer Research Assistant (VRA) mentor, The University of Edinburgh SEPTEMBER 2026 – PRESENT

Mentoring undergraduate VRA with Professor Martin Pickering

Local organiser, Linguistics Association of Great Britain (LAGB) Annual Meeting 2026, The University of Edinburgh SEPTEMBER 2026

Registered attendees and facilitated the running of the event

Chair, Holly Branigan & Martin Pickering's Psycholinguistics lab, The University of Edinburgh MARCH – AUGUST 2026

Chaired weekly meetings focusing on psycholinguistics-related topics

Reviewer, Journal of the Undergraduate Linguistics Association of Britain (JoULAB) MAY 2025 – PRESENT

Reviewed psycholinguistic research papers for JoULAB

Organising committee, Linguistics and English Language Postgraduate Conference (LELPGC25), The University of Edinburgh	SEPTEMBER 2024 – JUNE 2025
Organised the conference; chaired plenary talks on psycho-, socio- and developmental linguistics; participated in a panel discussion on <i>Making the most of your PhD</i> ; liaised with plenary speakers and workshop facilitators	
Chair, Bilingualism and Developmental Linguistics Research Group (BDLRG), The University of Edinburgh	SEPTEMBER 2024 – JUNE 2025
Organised, scheduled and chaired sessions; contacted internal and external speakers; managed budget and secured funding for external speakers' travel and accommodation costs and catering	
Organising committee, 30th Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP24), The University of Edinburgh	SEPTEMBER 2024
Registered and assisted attendees; coordinated attendee poster printing and set up posters	
Organising committee, Language Lunch @ Edinburgh, The University of Edinburgh	SEPTEMBER 2023 – JUNE 2024
Selected abstracts on language-related research for poster presentations and planned events	

ACCREDITATIONS

Associate Fellowship Advance HE, The University of Edinburgh	JUNE 2025
Received teaching accreditation for completion of the INTRODUCTION TO ACADEMIC PRACTICE course, demonstrating effective and inclusive teaching practice	
Introduction to Teaching Spanish as a Foreign Language, Instituto Cervantes & University of Deusto	NOVEMBER 2020
Received certification for completion of the course under the 2020 Teacher Training Programme (Spanish as a Foreign Language and other languages)	

TRAINING

Eye-tracking technical training, PPLS, The University of Edinburgh	NOVEMBER 2025
Completed eye-tracking training with SR Research EyeLink 2000 and successfully positioned the participant; adjusted camera focus; set thresholds for pupil and corneal reflection detection; completed calibration and validation	

UNDERGRADUATE DEVELOPMENT

Insights Facilitator, Careers Service, The University of Edinburgh	JANUARY – JUNE 2026
Supported undergraduate students from a Widening Participation background to gain work experience; provided advice on professional behaviour and communication	
Employ.ed Project Development Intern (Employ.ed for PhDs), Careers Service, The University of Edinburgh	AUGUST – DECEMBER 2025
Supervised and mentored two undergraduate interns; evaluated and provided feedback on the Employ.ed on Campus Summer and Semester programmes	

ADDITIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

English as a Foreign Language (EFL) Chief Activity Leader, STEP Language Services	JUNE – JULY 2023
EFL Teacher, STEP Language Services	OCTOBER 2022 – JUNE 2023
EFL Teacher & Chief Activity Leader, STEP Language Services	JULY – AUGUST 2022; JUNE – JULY 2021
EFL Teacher, Language School Bilbao	OCTOBER 2020 – JUNE 2021
EFL Activity Leader, STEP Language Services	JULY 2019
EFL Teacher, Laboratorio de Idiomas Jesuitak Indautxu	2019 – 2020; 2016 – 2018

LANGUAGES

English	NATIVE
Spanish	NATIVE
Basque	INTERMEDIATE
French	CEFR B1
Italian	CEFR B2
Turkish	BEGINNER

SKILLS

Programming	R
Tools	GITHUB, L ^A T _E X, JSPSYCH
Software	PRAAT, SR RESEARCH EYELINK